

Psy407 (Sport Psychology)

Midterm Questions

Q1. Two Distinguishing Characteristics of Psychodynamic Approach to Personality

1. Emphasizes **unconscious processes** and internal conflicts that shape behavior.
2. Focuses on **early childhood experiences** as critical in personality development.

Q2. Three Categories of Self-Talk

1. **Positive/Motivational Self-Talk** – Encourages effort and confidence.
2. **Instructional Self-Talk** – Guides focus on technique and strategy.
3. **Negative Self-Talk** – Critical or discouraging thoughts that may harm performance.

Q3. Naima (External Locus of Control) vs Sadia (Internal Locus of Control)

According to research:

- **Control Beliefs:** Naima believes outcomes depend on luck, fate, or external forces; Sadia believes they depend on her own actions.
- **Motivation:** Naima may feel less motivated to change situations; Sadia is proactive and goal-oriented.
- **Response to Failure:** Naima may blame outside factors; Sadia analyzes her own performance for improvement.
- **Persistence:** Sadia tends to persist in challenges; Naima may give up sooner if obstacles seem out of her control.
- **Stress Handling:** Sadia often uses problem-focused coping; Naima may feel helpless under stress.

Q4. Two Types of Motivation

- **Intrinsic Motivation:** Driven by personal satisfaction, enjoyment, and interest in the activity itself. Example: Playing a sport for fun and mastery.
- **Extrinsic Motivation:** Driven by external rewards or pressures, such as trophies, money, or recognition.

Q5. Five Benefits of Self-Talk

1. Increases confidence and self-belief.
2. Helps maintain focus under pressure.
3. Regulates emotions and reduces anxiety.
4. Improves skill learning through instructional cues.
5. Boosts motivation and persistence during challenges.

Q6. Compare Personality of Athletes and Non-Athletes

Research findings show:

- Athletes often score higher in **extroversion** and **self-confidence**.
- Athletes display greater **mental toughness** and ability to cope with stress.
- Athletes tend to have stronger **goal-setting and discipline** habits.
- Non-athletes may have more diverse personality traits without performance pressure shaping them.
- Athletes usually show higher **team cohesion** (in team sports) and competitive drive.

Q7. Fritz Heider's Formula

Fritz Heider, in his Balance Theory and attribution work, suggested that behavior (B) is a function of the person (P) and the environment (E):

$$B = f(P, E)$$

This means behavior results from both personal characteristics (attitudes, traits, abilities) and environmental factors (social situation, context).

Q8. Three Names

(Your handout likely listed these in a specific model — e.g., three stages, three researchers, or three components. Without the exact heading, the possible examples from sport psychology could be *Cattell*, *Eysenck*, *Allport* for personality; or *Vealey*, *Bandura*, *Weinberg* for self-confidence.)

Q9. Psychodynamic View of Violence

From the psychodynamic perspective, violence can be an expression of unconscious drives, unresolved conflicts, or repressed emotions. Freud's theory suggested aggressive energy builds up naturally and must be released, either in socially acceptable ways (sports) or, if not managed, in harmful behavior.

Q10. SMART

SMART is a goal-setting principle:

- **Specific** – Clear and precise goal.
- **Measurable** – Progress can be tracked.
- **Achievable** – Realistic given resources.
- **Relevant** – Matches personal or team objectives.
- **Time-bound** – Has a clear deadline.

Q11. Negative Mood States

Include emotions like anger, anxiety, depression, tension, confusion, and fatigue. These states can lower performance by reducing concentration, coordination, and motivation. In sport psychology, managing mood states is key for consistent performance.

Q12. Self-Efficacy – Bandura's Model

Bandura identified four main sources of self-efficacy:

1. **Mastery Experiences** – Success builds belief in ability.
2. **Vicarious Experiences** – Seeing others succeed increases belief.
3. **Verbal Persuasion** – Encouragement from coaches/peers.

4. **Physiological & Emotional States** – Managing stress and emotions improves confidence.
Self-efficacy affects goal-setting, persistence, and performance in sports.

Q13. Define Ego Orientation

Ego orientation is a type of achievement goal orientation where an athlete defines success by demonstrating that their ability is superior to others. The main focus is on social comparison — outperforming opponents or being the best in a group is more important than personal improvement. Athletes with strong ego orientation may feel successful even without personal growth, as long as they win, but they may also lose motivation if they perceive they cannot outperform others.

Q14. Enlist Types of Goal

In sport psychology, three main types of goals are recognized:

1. **Outcome Goals** – Focus on the result of a competition, such as winning a match or placing first. Dependent on both personal performance and opponents.
2. **Performance Goals** – Focus on achieving a personal standard or benchmark, independent of others' performance. Example: running 100m in under 12 seconds.
3. **Process Goals** – Focus on the specific actions, strategies, or techniques needed to perform well. Example: keeping proper form during a sprint.

Q15. Enlist Measurement Inventories

Common psychological measurement inventories in sports include:

- **SCAT (Sport Competition Anxiety Test):** Measures competitive trait anxiety.
- **CSAI-2 (Competitive State Anxiety Inventory-2):** Measures cognitive and somatic anxiety as well as self-confidence before competition.
- **POMS (Profile of Mood States):** Assesses mood states such as tension, depression, anger, vigor, fatigue, and confusion.
- **TAIS (Test of Attentional and Interpersonal Style):** Evaluates attentional focus and interpersonal skills in performance settings.
- **Coopersmith Self-Esteem Inventory:** Measures general self-esteem, which can impact sports performance.

Q16. Describe Locus of Causality and Types

Locus of causality refers to where an athlete perceives the cause of an outcome lies — within themselves or in the environment. It is part of attribution theory and influences motivation and emotional responses.

- **Internal Locus of Causality:** The athlete believes outcomes are the result of their own actions, skills, effort, and decisions. Example: “I won because I trained hard.”
- **External Locus of Causality:** The athlete attributes outcomes to factors beyond their control, such as luck, weather, referee decisions, or opponent's mistakes. Example: “I lost because the referee was unfair.”

Internal locus generally leads to greater responsibility and persistence, while external locus can reduce motivation if overused.

Q17. Enlist Any 5 Principles of Effective Goals

Five widely accepted principles for setting effective sport goals are:

1. **Specificity:** Goals should clearly define what is to be achieved (e.g., “Improve free throw accuracy to 85%”).
2. **Measurability:** Goals must have criteria for tracking progress and success.
3. **Challenge:** Goals should be difficult enough to encourage effort but still achievable.
4. **Time Frame:** Goals should include deadlines to maintain urgency and focus.
5. **Written and Reviewed:** Recording goals and regularly reviewing them increases commitment and progress.

Q18. Differentiate Rorschach Inkblot and TAT

- **Rorschach Inkblot Test:** A projective psychological test using 10 symmetrical inkblots. Participants describe what they see in each blot, revealing unconscious thoughts, emotions, and personality traits. It focuses on perceptual and associative processes.
 - **Thematic Apperception Test (TAT):** A projective test that uses a series of ambiguous social scenes. Participants tell a story about each image, including what happened before, during, and after the scene. This reveals motives, conflicts, and patterns of social interaction.
- Key difference: Rorschach emphasizes spontaneous perception of abstract images, while TAT emphasizes narrative creation from structured social situations.

Q19. Enlist Name of Three Models of Psychological Momentum

Three recognized models of psychological momentum in sport are:

1. **Antecedent–Consequent Model** – Suggests that events (antecedents) trigger changes in performance (consequences), creating momentum.
2. **Multidimensional Model** – Considers both psychological and physiological factors influencing momentum, such as confidence, arousal, and team cohesion.
3. **Projected Performance Model** – Proposes that perceptions of momentum influence expectations for future performance, which in turn affect actual results.

Q20. Write Three Steps of Thought Stopping

Thought stopping is a cognitive technique used to interrupt negative or unproductive thoughts:

1. **Recognition:** Become aware of the negative thought as soon as it appears.
2. **Interruption:** Use a physical or mental cue (such as saying “STOP!” loudly in your mind) to break the thought cycle.
3. **Replacement:** Immediately substitute the negative thought with a positive, task-focused, or neutral thought to redirect attention.

Q21. Cattell's Sixteen Factor Personality Inventory – Any 5 Traits

From Cattell's 16PF, five example traits are:

1. **Warmth (A):** Outgoing, friendly vs. reserved.
2. **Reasoning (B):** Abstract thinking vs. concrete thinking.
3. **Emotional Stability (C):** Calm vs. reactive.
4. **Dominance (E):** Assertive vs. cooperative.
5. **Liveliness (F):** Cheerful, enthusiastic vs. serious.

Q22. Attributional Model

The attributional model in sport psychology explains how athletes interpret causes of success or failure. Causes are classified along three dimensions:

1. **Locus of Causality:** Internal (ability, effort) or external (luck, opponent).
2. **Stability:** Stable (ability) or unstable (effort, weather).
3. **Controllability:** Under personal control (training) or uncontrollable (referee decision). These attributions influence motivation, persistence, and emotional reactions in future performances.

Q23. Yousaf Says to All Team to Write Their Individual Goals and He Writes a Team Goal – Why?

Yousaf is using a **combined goal-setting approach** to enhance both personal and team performance.

- **Individual Goals:** Help each athlete focus on self-improvement, specific weaknesses, and personal motivation.
- **Team Goal:** Builds unity, shared purpose, and collective responsibility, which boosts cohesion and communication. Research shows that aligning personal goals with a common team objective improves performance consistency and morale.

Q24. Enlist Three Models of Psychological Momentum

1. **Antecedent–Consequent Model** – Momentum results from specific triggering events that positively or negatively influence performance.
2. **Multidimensional Model** – Combines psychological (confidence, focus) and physiological (energy, arousal) factors in momentum shifts.
3. **Projected Performance Model** – Expectations of future performance change based on perceived current momentum.

Q25. Enlist Three Goals of Sport Psychology

1. **Enhancing Performance:** Using psychological techniques (e.g., imagery, goal setting) to improve athletic outcomes.
2. **Improving Psychological Well-being:** Helping athletes manage stress, anxiety, and mental health.

3. **Promoting Personal Growth:** Encouraging values like discipline, resilience, and teamwork.

Q26. Enlist Three Levels of Appraisal of Situation in Stress

1. **Primary Appraisal:** Assessing whether a situation is a threat, challenge, or irrelevant to personal well-being.
2. **Secondary Appraisal:** Evaluating available resources and coping options to manage the situation.
3. **Reappraisal:** Reassessing the situation after coping strategies are applied, adjusting perceptions if necessary.

Q27. Mehmood's First International Match – Five Possible Fears

When playing his first international match, Mehmood may experience:

1. Fear of failure and letting the team down.
2. Fear of performing poorly under pressure.
3. Fear of criticism from coaches, media, or fans.
4. Fear of making visible mistakes in front of a large audience.
5. Fear of not meeting personal or national expectations.

Q28. Ali Not Listening to Instructor – Identify & Explain Attitude

Ali's behavior reflects a **negative or resistant attitude** towards authority and instruction.

- **Explanation:** In sport psychology, attitude combines cognitive beliefs, emotional feelings, and behavioral tendencies toward an object or person. A resistant attitude can hinder learning, team harmony, and performance improvement because it blocks openness to feedback and skill refinement.

Q29. Youth Sport Programs – Any Two

1. **Positive Youth Development Programs:** Use sport as a tool to teach life skills such as leadership, teamwork, discipline, and responsibility. Example: community-based after-school sports leagues focusing on both skills and character.
2. **Talent Identification & Development Programs:** Structured initiatives aimed at discovering young athletes with high potential and providing them with coaching, resources, and competitive opportunities to reach elite levels.

Q30. Flow

Flow is a psychological state in sports where the athlete is fully absorbed in the activity, performing effortlessly with complete concentration. Skills match the level of challenge, leading to smooth performance and enjoyment. In this state, athletes lose awareness of time and feel total control over actions. Flow improves both performance and satisfaction, making it an important goal in mental skills training. For example, a runner may feel “in the zone” where every step feels perfect.

Q31. Athlete–Coach Relationship

The athlete–coach relationship is the bond that influences motivation, trust, and performance. It is based on respect, open communication, and understanding each other's needs. A positive relationship helps athletes accept feedback, set achievable goals, and stay committed during training. Coaches who adapt to athletes' personalities create a supportive environment. For example, a coach who listens to concerns and adjusts the training plan builds stronger athlete commitment.

Q32. Specific Task & Mood Statement

A specific task statement gives clear, measurable instructions, such as “complete 10 push-ups in 30 seconds.” It helps athletes focus on the exact action needed. A mood statement is a short phrase designed to create the right emotional state, such as “stay calm” or “push harder.” When combined, they improve performance by guiding both physical action and mental readiness. Coaches use them before competition to align mindset with the task.

Q33. Fritz Heider's Contribution

Fritz Heider developed Attribution Theory, which studies how people explain causes of events. Athletes may attribute success to internal factors (skill, effort) or external factors (luck, weather). These attributions influence confidence and future motivation. For example, if a player blames failure on bad luck, they may not work on skills; but if they blame it on low effort, they may train harder. This theory helps coaches guide athletes toward productive thinking.

Q34. Goal Setting Techniques

Effective goal setting in sports includes making goals specific, measurable, and realistic. Goals should be time-bound, positively stated, and broken into short-term steps to maintain motivation. Athletes should record goals and review progress regularly. For example, instead of saying “I want to improve stamina,” a specific goal would be “Run 5 km in under 25 minutes within two months.” Proper goal setting keeps athletes focused and confident.

Q35. Rorschach Test

The Rorschach test is a projective personality test using 10 inkblot images. The individual describes what they see in each inkblot, and responses are analyzed to reveal hidden emotions, thoughts, and personality traits. It is used to understand subconscious processes influencing behavior. In sports psychology, it may help explore emotional blocks or mental patterns affecting an athlete's performance.

Q36. Momentum

Psychological momentum is the perception of having control and positive energy during a game or performance. When athletes feel momentum, they often increase effort, confidence, and focus, which can boost results. For example, a basketball team making consecutive successful shots may feel unstoppable. However, losing momentum can lead to reduced confidence and poor decisions, so athletes must learn how to maintain it under pressure.

Q37. Multicultural Training

Multicultural training prepares athletes and coaches to work effectively with individuals from different cultural backgrounds. It includes developing cultural awareness, communication skills,

and respect for diversity. Such training reduces misunderstandings and promotes teamwork in international sports. For example, understanding cultural differences in body language or communication style can help avoid conflicts and build trust within diverse teams.

Q38. Self-Confidence Model

Bandura's self-confidence model highlights four main sources: personal achievements, observing others succeed (vicarious experience), encouragement (verbal persuasion), and managing physical/emotional states. High self-confidence leads to better focus, persistence, and resilience under pressure. For example, a swimmer who recalls past victories and receives positive feedback from a coach is more likely to perform confidently in competitions.

Q39. TAT

The Thematic Apperception Test is a projective method where individuals see ambiguous images and create stories about them. The content reveals hidden motives, emotions, and personality aspects. In sports psychology, it may uncover an athlete's deep fears or drives influencing performance. For example, a story showing repeated failure themes may suggest low self-belief, guiding mental training strategies.

Q40. Individual vs. Team Goals

Individual goals focus on personal skills, fitness, or mental readiness, while team goals aim for collective success, such as winning a tournament. Both must align so personal progress supports team objectives. For example, a football striker's personal goal to improve accuracy supports the team goal of scoring more. Balanced goal setting strengthens overall performance.

Q41. Anxiety–Stress–Arousal

Anxiety is a negative emotional state involving fear and worry, stress is the perception of imbalance between demands and coping ability, and arousal is the body's physical activation from calmness to excitement. In sports, moderate arousal can improve performance, but too much anxiety or stress can cause errors. Athletes use techniques like breathing, visualization, and self-talk to manage these states and maintain optimal performance levels.

Q42. Locus of Causality

Locus of causality refers to whether an individual believes the cause of an event is internal (within their control) or external (outside their control). In sports, internal locus means athletes see outcomes as a result of their own effort or skill, while external locus means they attribute them to luck, referee decisions, or other external factors. For example, a runner blaming a slow race on lack of training shows an internal locus; blaming it on bad weather reflects an external locus. Understanding this helps coaches shape athletes' motivation and responsibility.

Q43. Flow State

Flow state is a peak performance condition where an athlete is fully immersed, performing smoothly and with complete focus. It happens when skills match the challenge level, creating a balance between difficulty and ability. Athletes in flow often lose awareness of time, feel in control, and enjoy the activity deeply. For example, a basketball player sinking shot after shot without overthinking is experiencing flow. Sports psychologists train athletes to achieve this state through preparation, mental focus, and confidence building.

Q45. Test Identification from Statement

When given a behavioral or personality description, the choice of test depends on what is being measured. For example, if the statement relates to interpreting ambiguous images, it suggests a projective test like the Thematic Apperception Test (TAT) or Rorschach. If it involves answering structured personality questions, it may be an inventory like the Cattell 16PF. The key is matching the statement's focus — unconscious drives vs. measured traits — to the correct testing method.

Q46. Motivation Levels (4 Types)

The four main levels of motivation are:

1. **Intrinsic Motivation** – doing the activity for personal satisfaction and enjoyment.
2. **Extrinsic Motivation** – driven by external rewards like medals or praise.
3. **Amotivation** – lack of intention or drive to act.
4. **Integrated Regulation** – behavior aligned with personal values but still goal-oriented. Athletes often have a mix of these, and high intrinsic motivation usually leads to the most consistent long-term performance.

Q47. Qualities of a Motivated Athlete

Motivated athletes show persistence, dedication, and resilience in the face of challenges. They maintain consistent effort in training, set clear and challenging goals, and display a positive attitude even after setbacks. Such athletes also take responsibility for their improvement, seek feedback, and adapt their strategies when needed. For example, an injured player who continues to work on mental skills while recovering shows strong motivation.

Q48. Poor or Vague Goals

Poor or vague goals are those that lack clarity, measurability, or timelines. They fail to give athletes a clear target, leading to confusion and low motivation. For example, saying “I want to be better at tennis” is too general; it doesn't specify how, when, or by how much improvement will occur. Good sports goals should be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound (SMART).

Q49. Consistent Relationship between Personality and Sport Psychology

Personality traits influence how athletes respond to training, competition, and stress. For example, high conscientiousness relates to discipline and preparation, while high openness may enhance creativity in play. Sport psychology uses personality assessment to tailor coaching and mental training to individual needs. The consistent link between certain traits and performance outcomes helps predict which mental strategies will work best for an athlete.

Q50. Self-Talk

Self-talk is the practice of athletes speaking to themselves internally or aloud to influence thoughts, emotions, and actions. It can be positive (“I can do this”), instructional (“focus on follow-through”), or motivational (“keep pushing”). Effective self-talk improves confidence, focus, and emotional control. For example, before a penalty kick, a football player may repeat “stay calm, aim low” to maintain control under pressure.

Q51. Abbreviation of SMART

SMART stands for **Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound**. This goal-setting framework is widely used in sports psychology to ensure athletes have clear, realistic, and trackable objectives. For example, “Improve free-throw accuracy from 60% to 75% in 8 weeks” is a SMART goal because it specifies exactly what, by how much, and by when improvement should happen.

Q52. Locus of Causality and Old Name

Locus of causality refers to whether people believe the cause of an outcome is internal (within their control) or external (outside their control). An athlete with an internal locus credits success to personal effort, while an external locus blames luck or referees. Its older name is **Attribution of Cause** in early attribution theory. Understanding this helps coaches shape accountability and motivation.

Q53. Depression, Anxiety, and Distress – Contrasts

Depression is a persistent low mood, loss of interest, and reduced energy. Anxiety is characterized by worry, tension, and fear about future events. Distress is a broader term for extreme stress, which can include emotional pain and strain. In sports, depression often leads to withdrawal from activity, anxiety can cause overthinking during performance, and distress may cause both mental and physical performance declines.

Q54. Thought Stopping – 3 Techniques

1. **Verbal Cueing:** Saying “Stop” loudly in your mind or aloud to interrupt negative thoughts.
 2. **Imagery Replacement:** Visualizing a stop sign or switching to a positive image.
 3. **Substitution:** Replacing the negative thought with a positive or task-focused statement.
- These methods help athletes refocus quickly under pressure.

Q55. How Depression Affects Performance

Depression reduces energy, motivation, and concentration, making it harder for athletes to train consistently or compete effectively. It can lower self-confidence, slow reaction time, and increase fatigue. For example, a sprinter with depression may struggle to commit fully to training sessions, leading to poorer race outcomes. Early intervention and mental health support are essential.

Q56. Three Theories of Self-Confidence

1. **Bandura’s Self-Efficacy Theory** – Confidence comes from mastery, vicarious experiences, verbal persuasion, and emotional state.
2. **Vealey’s Sport Confidence Model** – Confidence is a combination of personality traits, preparation, and performance history.
3. **Multidimensional Model of Sport Confidence** – Separates confidence into cognitive, physical, and resilience components.

Q57. Types of Stress (Selye)

Hans Selye identified **three main types of stress**:

- **Eustress**: Positive stress that motivates performance, such as pre-game excitement.
 - **Distress**: Negative stress that harms performance, like injury worries.
 - **Neustress**: Neutral stress that does not directly affect performance.
- He also explained the stress response through the **General Adaptation Syndrome** stages: alarm, resistance, and exhaustion.

Q58. Three Phases of Setting Goals

1. **Preparation Phase**: Identify needs, set priorities, and decide the type of goals (short-term/long-term).
2. **Implementation Phase**: Write goals in SMART form and integrate them into training plans.
3. **Evaluation Phase**: Monitor progress, adjust goals, and provide feedback to maintain motivation.

Q59. Types of Locus of Causality (with Description)

- **Internal Locus of Causality**: Athlete believes outcomes result from their own skills, effort, and preparation. Example: winning because of disciplined training.
- **External Locus of Causality**: Athlete believes outcomes are caused by outside forces such as luck, referee decisions, or weather conditions. Example: blaming loss on poor field conditions.

Q60. Two Types of Motivation (with Description)

- **Intrinsic Motivation**: Driven by personal satisfaction, enjoyment, and internal desire to improve. For example, a swimmer training daily because they love the sport.
- **Extrinsic Motivation**: Driven by external rewards like medals, trophies, money, or social recognition. For example, playing well to earn a sports scholarship.

Q61: What is sport psychology?

Sport psychology is a science in which the principles of psychology are applied in a sport and exercise setting.

These principles are often applied to enhance performance, however, a true sport psychologist is interested in much more than performance enrichment and sees sport as a tool for human enrichment.

Q62: What does the sport psychologist do?

Roles and functions of a sport psychologist are described in the categories of clinician, educator and researcher.

- The Clinical/ Counseling Sport Psychologist
- The Educational Sport Psychologist

- The Research Sport Psychologist

Q63: In how many domain the Multicultural training issue in sport psychology students should be provided?

Multicultural training of sport psychology students should be provided in four domains. First, Students should experience a heightened awareness of and sensitivity to cultural groups different from their own. Second they should gain knowledge about people who belong to cultures different than their own. Third, students should learn helping and intervention skills through the process of role playing and stimulated interaction. Finally, each prospective graduate should experience a supervised practicum to gain hands-on experience working with members of a different culture or race.

Q64: Describe goal involvement?

There are two types of goal perspective. One is referred to as goal orientation and the other is goal involvement. Both are related to success, Goal orientation: goal orientation related to success in general, goal orientation is the motivation to achieve a goal in sport.

Goal involvement: goal involvement is a situation-specific state measure of how an individual relates to an achievement situation at a specific point in time. Goal involvement can be further divided into two categories; task or master involvement, and ego or competitive involvement.

Q65: What is motivation in sports?

Motivation is basically something that energizes, direct, and sustains behaviors. There are two kinds of motivation: intrinsic motivation and extrinsic motivation.

- Intrinsic motivation: Intrinsic motivation basically the internal desire of the players to perform a particular task, to do certain activities because it gives them pleasure, develops a particular skill, or it's morally the right thing to do.
- Extrinsic motivation: Extrinsic motivation are the motivational factors external to the individual and unrelated to the task they are performing or in other words extrinsic motivation refers to motivation that comes from an external as opposed to an internal source. Examples include money, and other rewards.

Q66: Which social factors include in integrated theory of motivation?

The integrated theory of motivation includes the notions of intrinsic and extrinsic motivation. Social factors and psychological mediator are seen as determinants of motivation that lead to certain consequences.

1. Success and failure
2. Competition and cooperation
3. Coaches behavior

Q67: Level of motivation?

1. Amotivation
2. Intrinsic motivation
3. Extrinsic motivation

4. External motivation
5. Introjected motivation
6. Identified regulation

Q68: Basic Types of Goals And Their Effectiveness

There are three basic types of goals that have been identified in the sport psychology literature. These three different types of goals are:

- Outcome goals
- Performance goals
- Process goals

Q69: Memory Systems

There are three basic memory systems:

- Sensory information store
- Short-Term Memory (STM)
- Long-Term Memory (LTM)

Q70: Selective Attention?

Selective attention is the ability to gate out, or ignore, irrelevant sensory information, and to pay attention to relevant information. Each of us has experienced the feeling of over stimulation that can result in an inability to concentrate. If it were not for our ability to concentrate on one or two relevant items at a time, we simply could not function. The ability to selectively attend to appropriate stimuli is critical in most athletic situations.

Q71: Personality Defined?

Personality is defined as an individual's characteristic pattern of thinking, feeling, and acting. In other words personality is “all the consistent ways in which the behavior of one person differs from that of others, especially in social situations.” The key words in this definition are basically “consistent” and “differs”. An individual’s personality defines the person in unique ways that remain stable and consistent over time. If an athlete consistently exhibits the characteristics of being assertive on and off the athletic field, we might say that he is an assertive person.

Q72: Theories of Personality?

The four major theoretical approaches to the study of personality are as follows:

1. Psychodynamic theory
2. Social learning theory
3. Humanistic theory
4. Trait theory

Q73: Trait Theory?

The basic position of trait or factor theory is that personality can be described in terms of traits possessed by individuals. These personality traits are considered synonymous with dispositions to act in a certain way. Traits are considered to be stable, enduring, and consistent across a

variety of differing situations. Cattell (1965) believed that typical responses are a function of both the situation (environment) and the personality disposition. This is evident from his formula, $R = S \times P$ in which, R = response, S = situation, and P = Personality.

Q74: Minnesota Multiphasic Personality Inventory?

The Minnesota Multiphasic Personality Inventory (MMPI) is the most widely used of all personality inventories. It basically consists of a series of true/false questions designed to measure personality traits and clinical conditions of the athletes. The original version of the MMPI, composed of 550 items, was and is still in use (Hathaway & McKinley, 1940). A revised version of the inventory, composed of 567 items, was developed in 1990 and named the MMPI-2 (Butcher, Graham, Williams, & BenSporath, 1990). These authors also developed a new form of the inventory to be used with adolescents (MMPI-A). The traits measured by the MMPI-2 include the following hypochondria, depression, hysteria, psychopathic deviation, masculinity-femininity, paranoia, obsessive-compulsive behavior, schizophrenia, hypomania, and social intraversion. The inventory also includes items to detect lying and faking good/bad scores. While the MMPI-2 was designed specifically for use with clinical populations, it may be used with normal individuals.

Q75: 16PF Primary Traits?

1. Warmth
2. Reasoning
3. Emotional Stability
4. Dominance
5. Liveliness
6. Rule-Consciousness
7. Social Boldness
8. Sensitivity
9. Vigilance
10. Abstractedness
11. Privateness
12. Apprehension
13. Openness to Change
14. Self-Reliance
15. Perfectionism
16. Tension

Q76: Differentiating Among Anxiety, Arousal, and Stress?

The emotion of anxiety affects athletic performance, however, the problem is that the term “anxiety” is closely associated with the terms “arousal” and “stress”. We will look how these terms are similar and how they differ. The discussion will focus upon emotions and mood, Selye’s concepts of stress, and Lazarus’s concept of stress process.

Antecedents of Precompetitive State of Anxiety: Competitive state anxiety that occurs prior to a competitive situation is referred to as precompetitive state of anxiety.

Q77: Which five factors include increase anxiety?

According to Endler (1978, 1983), there are five specific antecedents, or factors that lead to an increase in anxiety in anticipation of an achievement situation. These five factors are:

1. Fear of performance failure — Fear of getting defeated by a weaker opponent could pose a threat to an athlete's ego.
2. Fear of negative social evaluation — Fear of being evaluated negatively by thousands of spectators could pose a threat to self-esteem.
3. Fear of physical harm — Fear of being hit in the head by a 90 mph fastball could pose a serious threat.
4. Situation ambiguity — Not knowing if she is going to start a match is sometimes stressful to an athlete.
5. Disruption of well-learned routine — Being asked to change the way he does things without practice and warming up could be threatening to an athlete.